North Yellowstone Education Foundation

ANNUAL REPORT 2024

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www.GardinerNYEF.org

PO BOX 166
Gardiner, MT 59030

DEAR FRIENDS & DONORS

Strategic Highlights

North Yellowstone Education Foundation (aka NYEF) is proud to support Gardiner School in our three focus areas, Connect! Grants, Mental Health, and the Teacher Housing Initiative.

In the 2023-2024 school year, NYEF supported $62,185.25 in Connect! Grant requests. For the 2024-2025 school year, we plan to support over $100,000 in Connect! Grants.

The Teacher Housing initiative made great strides in 2024. We completed a remodel of our third-floor unit. We acquired another property, which allows us to offer five apartments for the Gardiner School. Additionally, NYEF began collaborations with Gardiner School, and in 2025, plans to add three manufactured homes to the school's property.

Financial Highlights

In 2024, we raised $311,111 in grants and $295,781 in donations.

Operating Highlights

In addition to achieving our goals in our three focus areas, NYEF pivoted to assist with Gardiner School's failed sound system. We obtained a $50,000 grant from the Park County Community Foundation Art Council and raised $14,407 at the end of the year in support of this important project.

Our Mission

"Working with the community to build sustainable support and enhance innovative educational opportunities for students, teachers, and community members in partnership with Gardiner Public Schools."

Looking Ahead

The Gardiner School is navigating financial challenges with resilience and hope. NYEF is committed to partnering with the school to ensure the well-being of our students and staff. With the additional housing expected in 2025, we are optimistic about securing sufficient units for the years to come. Once housing is stabilized, NYEF will shift its focus to enhancing mental health support for our students. Data from 2024 indicates that our 8th – 12th grade students are experiencing higher self-reported depressive symptoms compared to their peers across Park County. NYEF will continue its impactful collaborations with Live Well 49, Park County Coalition, and Park County Early Childhood Coalition. In many respects, the Gardiner School is flourishing. Our students are actively engaged in a diverse array of activities, from sports to drama to FFA, showcasing their talents and passions. NYEF will continue to look for innovative grants and resources to help our students thrive.

Jessica Warren

Jessica Warren
Board Chairperson

Gardiner Winning Team at World Quest.

PROGRAM SUMMARIES

Connect! Grant

During the 2023-2024 school year, our team of volunteers reviewed a total of 20 Connect! Grant applications, each showcasing innovative ideas aimed at enhancing educational experiences within our community. After careful consideration, we awarded funding to 18 of these applications, totaling $62,185.25. This selection reflects our commitment to supporting projects that demonstrate potential impact and sustainability. Additionally, we carried over 4 more applications to the fall of the '24-'25 school year, ensuring that we continue to explore opportunities for funding worthy initiatives that align with our goals early in the school year.

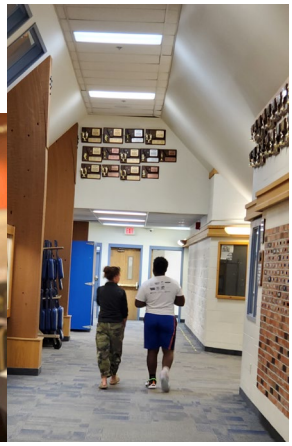
- 15 Classroom Grants awarded for the 2023-2024 school year. 3 awarded for fall 24-'25.
- 1157 students served, 129 teachers, 675 parents, and 440 others for 2401 total served. *

Grants 2024	Amount Funded	Grants 2024	Amount Funded
Bruin Buddy Reading	$274.25	World Quest	$1,145
Snoopy Cooperative Expansion Project	$1,400	Park County Middle School Band Festival	$1,000
FFA Ag Expo	$1,500	Y2 Europe	$1,900
K-6 Intervention Assistance	$20,000	Traffic Education Class	$2,177
Marching Band Equipment	$1,800	School Kitchen	$18,349
Operation Building Kids	$500	Activity Card Support	$500
Revamping PE	$500	Maintaining Momentum	$500
Farm to School	$5,000	Operation Building Kids pt 2	$1,600
8th Grade Ecology Trip	$4,000		

Mental Health

We received a mental health application for a Connect! Grant in support of the Rural Resilience initiative, requesting $10,000 in funding. After careful consideration, the board unanimously approved a generous allocation of $20,000 to further bolster this important project. Additionally, Rural Resilience successfully secured a matching grant from AMB West Philanthropies, significantly enhancing the project's financial foundation and impact.

- 55 students served, 31 teachers, 25 parents, for 123 total served. *



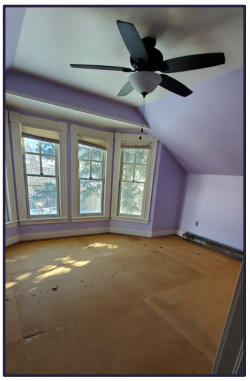
In cooperation with Rural Resilience, Gardiner School continues to use Bruin Strong as its school-wide social-emotional learning program. Students also benefit from the support of Bridget Kelly, the Lead Behavior Analyst for Rural Resilience. Bridget works with students one-on-one or in small groups to navigate classroom dynamics and peer relationships.

**Note: students, teachers, parents, and others are counted each time they participate in a NYEF Connect! Grant. Connect! Grants are represented by the school year in this report.*

Teacher Housing Initiative

Gardiner, MT, is facing a housing crisis. The Successful Gardiner Campaign in 2019 identified affordable housing as the top concern for residents. This crisis has affected the Gardiner Public School's ability to hire and retain teachers, as the starting salary is only $41,615. NYEF is working to address this issue through our Teacher Housing Initiative.

At the beginning of 2024, we had three apartments available for school staff. The two-bedroom unit and the second-floor unit were completed and remodeled as part of the original project. However, the third-floor unit was not. In spring 2024, we took on the remodel of the third-floor apartment. This was a collaboration of many community members, the Gardiner School Honor Society, First Interstate Bank, Community Closet, Livingston Ace Hardware, Livingston Flooring, and Hepburn Electric.

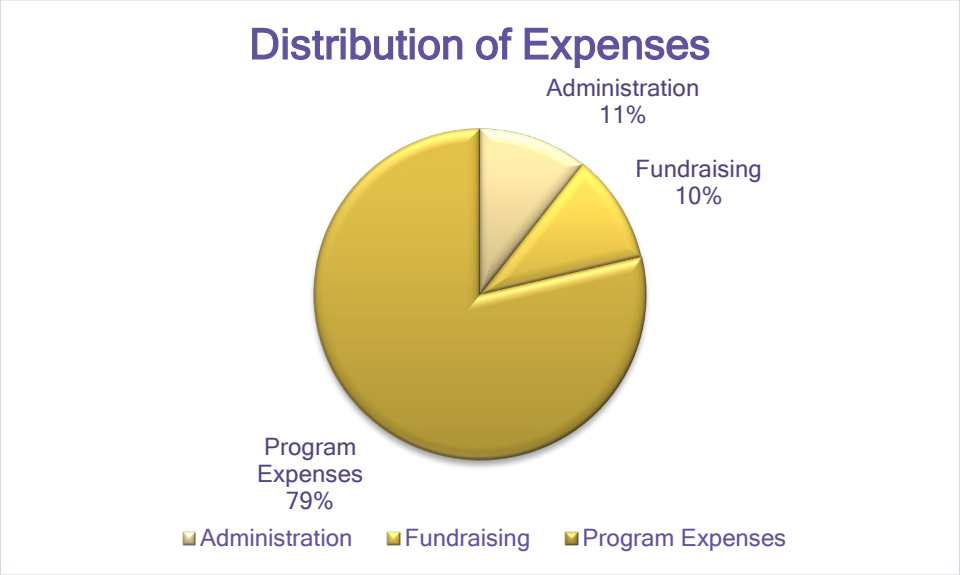


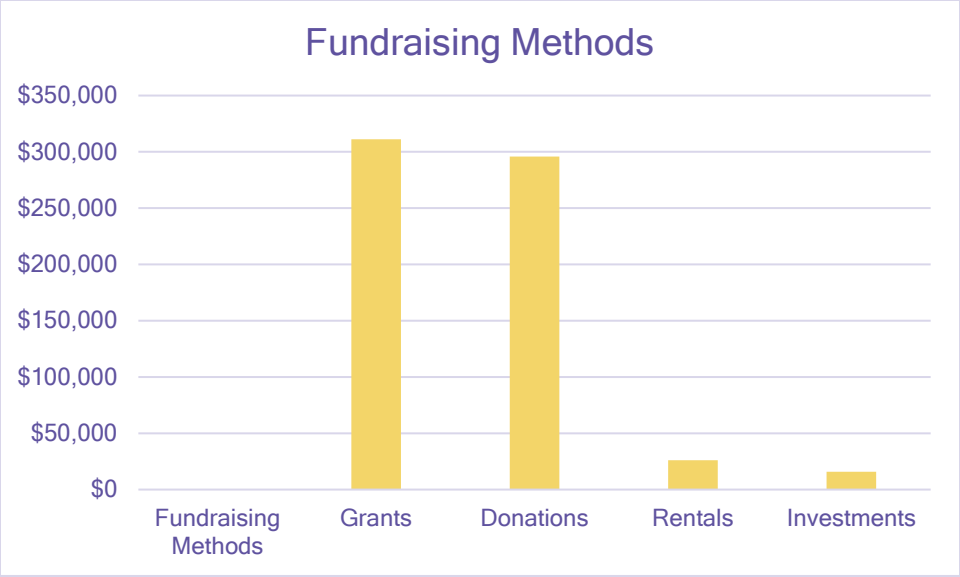
In July, with the help of an incredible donor, we acquired a second housing unit that contains two apartments: a two-bedroom and a studio. We quickly found tenants for both units. The studio apartment was occupied by a teacher intern until early fall. In December, we began a remodel of the studio apartment into a one-bedroom apartment with a grant from the Park County Community Foundation.

In December, NYEF began communications with the school regarding our ability to lease the school land to add three additional manufactured homes. These homes are expected to be completed by the 2025-2026 school year.

FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

Total Raised in 2024
$654,940





Statement of Financial Position

North Yellowstone Education Foundation

As of December 31, 2024

Distribution account	Total
Assets	
Current Assets	
Bank Accounts	
Checking	30,922.45
Money Market	191,801.78
SAV BUS	100,746.63
X M CD	583,419.37
Total for Bank Accounts	**$906,890.23**
Accounts Receivable	
Accounts Receivable (A/R)	
Total for Accounts Receivable	**0.00**
Other Current Assets	
1300 Undeposited Funds	
Total for Other Current Assets	**0.00**
Total for Current Assets	**$906,890.23**
Fixed Assets	
1600 B&B	389,377.32
1610 B&B Improvements	274,909.00
1615 B&B Land	95,850.00
Accumulated Depreciation	-67,890.00
Total for 1600 B&B	**$692,246.32**
Total for Fixed Assets	**$692,246.32**
Other Assets	
1500 Retainer-Attorney	
1800 LPLC Bridge Loan	
1900 Security Deposits	-2,950.00
Total for Other Assets	**-$2,950.00**
Total for Assets	**$1,596,186.55**
Liabilities and Equity	
Liabilities	
Current Liabilities	
Accounts Payable	
2000 Accounts Payable (A/P)	615.00
Total for Accounts Payable	**$615.00**
Credit Cards	
Other Current Liabilities	
2100 YE Liabilities	
Total for Other Current Liabilities	**0.00**
Total for Current Liabilities	**$615.00**
Total for Liabilities	**$615.00**
Equity	
Retained Earnings	1,175,892.07
Net Income	419,679.48
Total for Equity	**$1,595,571.55**
Total for Liabilities and Equity	**$1,596,186.55**

"NYEF has made things possible for Gardiner Schools that we never would have dreamed of being able to provide without their help. Those gifts include Connect Grants given to classrooms for innovate units of study and field trips, funding for a comprehensive K-12 Place Based Education program (including teacher training), a sustainable and community involved garden program in partnership with Farm to School, and unparalleled support in grant writing and networking on behalf of the school for various other projects. In addition to all of this, NYEF has been able to pay for and provide fantastic housing opportunities for our teachers and staff who need it, allowing us to bring in highly qualified and dedicated employees. Gardiner Schools could not do what we do without NYEF support!

Dr. Jeannette Bray Superintendent

Gardiner Public Schools

Takeaways

The current success of our teacher housing initiative demonstrates the local community's strong support for our teachers. We could not have accomplished remodels and additional units without the help of local volunteers, and support from local businesses, and generous donors.

In 2025, we expect to see additional teacher requests through Connect! Grants as funding continues to be a challenge for the school. NYEF will continue to support these requests and seek additional sources of revenue to ensure our teachers are creating innovative opportunities for our students.

NYEF's collaboration with Rural Resilience is imperative for the mental health of our students. We look forward to increasing our support of these needed programs.

PO Box 166
Gardiner, MT 59030

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Katy Melton, Board Member

Kaitlyn Parsons, Student Member

Staff

Laura Chastain, Director

Photo Credits by page

(1) World Quest by Christina Cote

(3) World Quest by Christina Cote

(4) Bruin Buddies by Erin Thom, Drivers Education by Jeanne Johnson, Livingston Band Festival by Kiara Carlson, Kitchen Update by Laura Chastain, Y2E Trip by Chrstina Cote, 8th Grade Ecology by Willa Fouts

(5) Rural Resilience by Jenny Malloy, Student in Hall by Laura Chastain

(6) Teacher House photos by Laura Chastain

(7) Gardiner School by Laura Chastain